

にんちしょう かた か い わ
認知症の方との会話

Dementia Communication — Calm, Simple, Patient Responses — Scenario Dialogue

Can-do: Answer a resident with dementia who wants to go home or asks the same question again: accept what she says instead of correcting it, keep your sentences short, redirect gently, and stay beside her until she settles.

1 · Dialogue & Why — 会話

Tanaka-san
(resident)

ねえ、そろそろ うちに 帰りますね。娘が 待っているのよ。

Listen, I'll be going home soon. My daughter is waiting for me.

Why: 帰宅願望 — wanting to go home — is one of the most common things you will hear on an afternoon shift. She is not lying and she is not testing you: for her, right now, this is true. ~のよ is 女性語, an older woman explaining something to you.

Hana
(caregiver)

そうですか。娘さんが 待って いらっしゃるんですね。

I see. Your daughter is waiting for you, is she.

Why: The whole lesson is in this line: repeat her words back instead of correcting them. いらっしゃる is 尊敬語 for いる — you are speaking respectfully about her family. ~んですね says 'I have understood you', which is what she actually needs. Correcting her only starts an argument you cannot win, and she will keep the fear long after she has forgotten your sentence.

Tanaka-san
(resident)

そうなの。何時の バスかしら。

That's right. I wonder what time the bus is.

Why: かしら is a soft 'I wonder', 女性語. She is asking for a fact you cannot give her — so do not answer the fact. Answer the worry underneath it: she wants to know she is not stranded and not forgotten.

Hana
(caregiver)

ご心配ですね。つらいですね。

You're worried, aren't you. That must be hard.

Why: Name the feeling before you do anything else (つらいですね, Ep 15). Two short sentences — with dementia, long explanations are noise. Say one idea, then stop and let her hear it.

Hana
(caregiver)

お茶を 飲んでから、一緒に 考えませんか。

Shall we have some tea first, and think about it together?

Why: This is redirection, and notice what it does NOT do: it never says no. ~てから = 'after doing ~', so going home is not refused, only placed after the tea. 一緒に makes it something you do with her, not to her (Ep 9). Very often the coat comes off during the tea and the subject changes on its own.

仕事日本語 · Shigoto Nihongo
Tanaka-san
(resident)

じゃあ、少し いただいわ。

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Well then, I'll have a little.

Why: いただく is the humble 'receive / have', and ～わ is again 女性語. The redirection landed. Do not now announce that she has forgotten about going home — just pour the tea.

Hana
(caregiver)

ありがとうございます。ゆっくりで 大丈夫ですよ。無理には しませんよ。

Thank you. Take your time — that's fine. I won't push you.

Why: Hurry is what turns confusion into fear. ゆっくりで 大丈夫ですよ removes the clock, and 無理には しませんよ (Ep 14) tells her she keeps the right to say no. Both are short enough to be understood on a bad afternoon.

Tanaka-san
(resident)

ねえ、さっきの こと、もう 一度 聞いてもいい？

Say, can I ask you about that again?

Why: The same question, again. ～ても いい？ is 'may I?' — she is asking permission, which means some part of her knows she has asked before. That is exactly why your face matters more than your answer here.

Hana
(caregiver)

はい、何度でも どうぞ。ゆっくり お話ししますね。

Yes — as many times as you like. I'll go through it slowly.

Why: 何度でも どうぞ = 'as many times as you like'. Say it warmly, the tenth time exactly as you said it the first — she cannot remember the question, but she will read your tone perfectly. お話しします is the humble 'I will explain'.

Hana
(caregiver)

まど 窓の そばに すわ 座りませんか。お ち づ ち 落ち着くまで、そばに いますね。

Shall we sit by the window? I'll stay with you until you settle.

Why: A calm place and a familiar person do more than any sentence. ～まで = 'until', so you are promising to stay for as long as it takes, not for a minute. Sitting down beside her also puts your eyes at her level, which reads as 'I am not leaving'.

Hana
(caregiver)

た な か 田中さんの ペースで 大丈夫ですよ。娘さんには、私から ご連絡いたし ますね。

Your own pace is fine, Tanaka-san. I'll call your daughter myself.

Why: Close by handing the day back to her (～さんの ペースで, Ep 14) and by taking the one job she was worried about off her hands. ご連絡いたします is humble 'I will contact them' (Ep 16) — and it is a promise you must actually keep.

2・Key Vocabulary — 語彙

#	日本語 仕事日本語・Shigoto Nihongo	ROMAJI	ENGLISH	メモ / NOTES
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1	かえ 帰る	<i>kaeru</i>	to go home; return	
2	むすめ 娘	<i>musume</i>	daughter	
3	ま 待つ	<i>matsu</i>	to wait	
4	いらっしゃる	<i>irassharu</i>	to be (respectful form of いる)	
5	しんぱい 心配	<i>shinpai</i>	worry; anxiety (recycled from Ep 16)	
6	つらい	<i>tsurai</i>	hard; painful to bear (recycled from Ep 15)	
7	ちゃ お茶	<i>ocha</i>	tea	
8	かんが 考える	<i>kangaeru</i>	to think about; consider	
9	だいじょうぶ 大丈夫	<i>daijoubu</i>	okay; all right (recycled from Ep 16)	
10	むり 無理に	<i>murini</i>	forcibly; against someone's will	
11	いちど もう一度	<i>mouichido</i>	once more; again	
12	なんど 何度でも	<i>nandodemo</i>	as many times as you like	
13	まど 窓	<i>mado</i>	window	
14	すわ 座る	<i>suwaru</i>	to sit down	
15	おちつ 落ち着く	<i>ochitsuku</i>	to calm down; settle	
16	ペース		pace; one's own speed (recycled from Ep 16)	
17	れんらく 連絡する	<i>renrakusuru</i>	to contact; get in touch (recycled from Ep 16)	

3・Patterns to Reuse — 使える かたち

PATTERN	MEANING & USE
～んですね 仕事日本語 · Shigoto Nihongo	Repeat her words back instead of correcting them Free video lessons on YouTube: 40-17: Semjita Communication

しんぱい ご心配ですね	Name the feeling before you answer anything
いっしょ ～てから、一緒に～ま せんか	Redirect gently — never say no outright
なんど 何度でも どうぞ	Answer the same question again, warmly
お　つ 落ち着くまで、そばに いますね	Stay beside her until she settles

4・Practice — れんしゅう

Say / write it in Japanese, then check with the answer key.

#	SAY THIS IN JAPANESE	YOUR ANSWER
1	What does Hana offer when Tanaka-san asks about the bus? A) 電話 B) お茶 C) お風呂 D) お薬	
2	Tanaka-san asks the same question again. What does Hana say? A) さっき 言 いましたよ B) 何度でも どうぞ C) あとで ですね D) 忘れしましたか	
3	Repeat her words back: 'Your daughter is waiting for you, is she.'	
4	Name the feeling: 'You're worried, aren't you.'	
5	Promise to stay: 'I'll be beside you until you feel settled.'	

5・Answer Key — こたえ

1. お茶を 飲んでから、一緒に 考えませんか。
2. はい、何度でも どうぞ。
3. 娘さんが 待って いらっしゃるんですね。
4. ご心配ですね。
5. 落ち着くまで、そばに いますね。